

Part 4: Reflection

1. **Initial Access & Credentials** I connected to the server, get my database details, and changed my password. I think Institutions enforce mandatory password changes on first login to prevent unauthorized reuse of default credentials and reduce risks like surface attacks or insider misuse.
2. **Error Encountered** I faced a database connection failure after updating db.php using the live server credentials. Diagnosing it, involved checking credentials, file paths, and error logs. This taught me that servers often hide sensitive error details from users for security, while developers must rely on error from the server or debugging tools.
3. **Local vs. Live Deployment** Working locally with XAMPP is easy and flexible. But once code is on a shared server, you must think about security, permissions, and multiple users. Live deployment also requires careful handling of passwords and file access.